

# Peer Review Pack

*Music Works Catalogue Portal — Prototype*  
*Computer Science Final Year Project · April–August 2026*

Thank you for reviewing this prototype. This pack contains everything you need: a short overview, step-by-step instructions to run the project, the tasks to try, and three questions to answer. The whole process should take about ten minutes.

## 1. What This Project Is

The Music Works Catalogue Portal makes classical-composer thematic catalogues — detailed scholarly records of every work a composer wrote — searchable and browsable through a modern web interface and API. The underlying data is encoded in MEI XML, a specialist music-encoding standard that is normally inaccessible without technical knowledge. This prototype transforms that data and presents it in a way anyone can explore, including a feature that suggests melodically similar works.

## 2. Software and Hardware Required

- Operating system: Windows, macOS, or Linux (any recent version).
- Python 3.10 or newer — the only required software. This is the same Python used in our modules. Check your version with: `python3 --version`
- A web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Edge, or Safari) — you almost certainly already have one.
- No database, no build tools, and no internet connection are required — everything runs locally on your machine.

Hardware: any standard laptop or desktop is sufficient. The prototype is lightweight and uses only a few megabytes of data.

## 3. How to Access the Project

This project runs locally on your own computer — there is no website to visit. You download the project folder, run it with Python (the same Python used in our modules), and it opens in your web browser at a local address. The whole process is four commands and takes about two minutes. Everything runs offline on your machine; nothing is uploaded or shared, and no account or internet connection is needed. Full step-by-step commands are below.

## 4. How to Run the Project

Unzip the project folder, open a terminal inside it, and run the four commands below. Lines starting with a hash are comments.

### On macOS or Linux

```
# 1. Create and activate a virtual environment
python3 -m venv venv
source venv/bin/activate

# 2. Install the dependencies
pip install -r requirements.txt

# 3. Build the database and start the server
./run.sh
```

### On Windows

```
python -m venv venv
venv\Scripts\activate
pip install -r requirements.txt
python transform\pipeline.py data catalogue.db
uvicorn api.main:app --reload
```

When the terminal shows “Application startup complete”, open your web browser and go to:

<http://localhost:8000/>

You should see the catalogue portal. (If the web page does not appear, the interactive API is also available at <http://localhost:8000/docs>.) To stop the server when you are finished, click the terminal and press Ctrl + C.

## 5. What You Will See

The screenshot shows the Music Works Catalogue web application. The header features the title "Music Works Catalogue" and the tagline "Exploring the thematic catalogues of classical composers". Below the header is a search bar with the placeholder text "Search by title, composer, or genre...". To the right of the search bar are buttons for "SEARCH", "All catalogues" (with a dropdown arrow), and "RESET".

The main content area displays a list of works under the heading "6 WORK(S) IN VIEW". The works listed are:

- Romance for Violin and Piano** (CNW 60) by Carl Nielsen, Chamber music
- Symphony No. 4 "The Inextinguishable"** (CNW 102) by Carl Nielsen, Symphony
- Summer Song** (CNW 128) by Carl Nielsen, Song
- Greeting** (CNW 131) by Carl Nielsen, Song
- Ukendt værk** (CNW 999) by Carl Nielsen, —
- On Hearing the First Cuckoo in Spring**

On the right side, there is a detailed view for the selected work, "Romance for Violin and Piano" by Carl Nielsen. This view includes a table of metadata:

|                 |                              |
|-----------------|------------------------------|
| OPUS            | not recorded                 |
| GENRE           | Chamber music                |
| DATE            | c. 1882–83                   |
| DANISH TITLE    | not recorded                 |
| ENGLISH TITLE   | Romance for Violin and Piano |
| INSTRUMENTATION | violin, pianoforte (piano)   |
| TEMPO           | Andante                      |
| KEY             | G major                      |
| METER           | 4/4                          |
| INCIPIT         | G4 · B4 · D5 · G5 · F#5      |

*The prototype interface: a searchable work list on the left, full details on the right, and melodically similar works below.*

## **6. Tasks to Try Before Answering**

Please spend a few minutes trying the following, so your answers reflect real use:

1. Browse the list of works on the left, and click one to see its full details on the right.
2. Use the search box to search for something — try “song”, “symphony”, or a composer name like “Nielsen” — and see what comes back.
3. Use the catalogue filter to switch between the two catalogues (Carl Nielsen and Frederick Delius).
4. On a work’s detail page, look at the “Melodically similar works” suggestions at the bottom, and click one to jump to it.

## **7. Please Answer These Three Questions**

For each statement, please choose the response that best reflects your experience, on the following scale: Agree · Partially agree · Neither agree nor disagree · Partially disagree · Disagree

**Q1. I could easily understand how to use the interface to find and view a work.**

**Q2. The search and filter results were appropriate and relevant to what I was looking for.**

**Q3. The information shown for each work (including titles, details, and the “melodically similar works” suggestions) was presented clearly and was easy to understand.**

If you have any additional comments — anything confusing, anything you liked, or anything you would change — please add them below your answers. Free-text feedback is very welcome but optional.